

Contractor Discovery & Workflow Diagnosis Training

Prepared 2026-08-07 · For a 20–30 minute contractor workflow interview

You are not selling “AI automation.” You are helping a home-service business find where new requests get missed, delayed, or handed off poorly — then giving them a practical, bounded fix plan.

FIRST-CALL OBJECTIVE

Leave with:

- One clearly defined workflow
- One verified bottleneck
- One owner responsible for that process
- One measurable clarity improvement
- Enough sanitized information for a diagnosis

Do not try to sell:

- A chatbot, CRM, texting system, or full build
- Guaranteed revenue, bookings, or response-time results
- Access to systems, credentials, recordings, or customer data
- Autonomous customer contact or emergency decisions

YOUR OPENING

“I’m looking at one narrow part of your operation: what happens when a new request comes in but nobody immediately answers, books it, or assigns the follow-up. I’m not asking for passwords or access to your systems. I want to understand the process, identify where requests get stuck, and show you a practical improvement plan.”

Set the expectation plainly:

“This is a workflow diagnostic, not a promise of more revenue, more bookings, emergency-response coverage, or guaranteed results.”

CALL STRUCTURE

Minutes	Purpose	Output
0–3	Set scope and data boundary	Agreement: one workflow, no credentials or private records
3–10	Understand business and request channels	Who, what, when, and where requests arrive
10–20	Walk one recent sanitized example	Actual workflow map and failure point
20–27	Identify desired improvement and constraints	Initial improvement hypothesis
27–30	Summarize, confirm, and close	Next review step and approved data boundary

Ask in This Order

A. UNDERSTAND THE BUSINESS

- What type of work do you mainly handle?
- How many people handle calls, forms, scheduling, or dispatch?
- What are normal business hours? What happens after hours?
- Which requests are urgent or safety-sensitive?

B. MAP HOW REQUESTS ARRIVE

- Phone, voicemail, website form, email, chat, referrals, ads?
- Which channel creates the most problems?
- Who sees each type of request?
- Are requests stored in one place or several?
- What happens when two people respond to the same request?

C. FOLLOW ONE REAL EXAMPLE

Ask: *"Can you walk me through the last time a request came in while nobody was immediately available?"*

1. When and where did it arrive?
2. Who noticed it?
3. What information was captured?
4. Was urgency identified?
5. Who owned the callback?
6. When did someone respond?
7. Was it booked, deferred, lost, or unresolved?
8. Where was that status recorded?

D. FIND THE FAILURE POINT

- Where do requests most often get stuck?
- Is the issue missed calls, slow callbacks, incomplete information, unclear ownership, or poor status tracking?
- What information does dispatch need before assigning work?
- What happens when the assigned person is unavailable?
- How do you know which requests still need attention?
- Do you review missed or delayed requests weekly?

E. UNDERSTAND TOOLS — NAMES AND WORKFLOW ONLY

- What scheduling or dispatch system do you use?
- ServiceTitan, Housecall Pro, Jobber, FieldEdge, spreadsheets, calendars, or something else?
- Which tool receives the original request? Which is the official record?
- What manual copying happens between systems?

Do not request: passwords, API keys, login links, private call recordings, or credentials.

USEFUL PROMPT WHEN ANSWERS ARE VAGUE

"Let's stay with the last real example. What happened next, who was supposed to act, and how would you know whether it was resolved?"

What to Gather — and What Not to Gather

You need enough information to reconstruct one workflow, not their entire business.

Category	Information needed
Trigger	What starts the process: phone call, form, voicemail, email?
Intake	What information is captured?
Classification	Repair, install, maintenance, urgent, or other?
Ownership	Who is responsible for the next action and who backs them up?
Timing	When should the next action happen?
Status	New, contacted, booked, awaiting information, closed, lost
Handoff	What must dispatch or the technician know?
Failure / exception	Where does it break, and what requires human judgment or escalation?
Tools / volume	Systems used; approximate requests per day or week
Desired improvement	What would make work easier or more visible?

ASK FOR SANITIZED EXAMPLES ONLY

Allowed:

- Date and approximate time
- Channel and job-type category
- Urgency category
- Current status and callback owner
- Approximate first-response timing
- Missing-information and handoff flags

Exclude:

- Names, phone numbers, email addresses
- Physical addresses and payment details
- Recordings, private notes, customer account data
- Passwords, tokens, API keys, screenshots of private systems

CAPTURE THE WORKFLOW DURING THE CALL

```
Request arrives
↓
Where is it captured? → Who sees it? → Who classifies urgency?
↓
Who owns the callback? → Where is status recorded?
↓
What happens if nobody responds? → How does dispatch get complete information?
```

At each step, record: **current process · owner · tool · expected timing · actual failure · recommended improvement.**

How Veritas Will Diagnose the Workflow

Send your structured notes after the call. Veritas will turn them into a grounded diagnosis:

1. Current-state workflow map

2. Bottleneck and failure-mode analysis

3. Missing-field and ownership analysis

4. Prioritized fixes

5. Automation-suitability assessment
6. Tool-fit recommendation

7. Implementation sequence

8. QA and fallback plan

9. Measurement plan

THREE CATEGORIES OF RECOMMENDATION

Type	Examples	Authority / timing
Immediate manual fixes	Standard intake checklist; "new request" status; callback owner plus backup; daily unresolved-request review; required dispatch fields.	Safest and fastest. Client owns adoption.
Review-only automation design	Attention queue; unassigned-request flag; drafted follow-up reminder; daily missed-request digest; incomplete-handoff detector.	Can be designed without touching systems.
Actual system implementation	CRM, form, email, phone, calendar, Zapier, Make, n8n, or custom workflow connection.	Separate scoped project with explicit authorization, testing, rollback, and access controls.

AUTOMATION BLUEPRINT FOR EVERY PROPOSED FIX

Trigger: What starts the workflow?

Required inputs: What minimum fields are needed?

Unique record ID: How are duplicates handled?

Ordered actions: What happens in sequence?

Human review checkpoint: What must a person confirm?

Notification path: Who is told, where, and when?

Retry / failure fallback: What happens if a tool or person fails?

Audit/status trail: How is it visible and reviewable?

Tool candidate: Which tool fits the current environment?

Activation state: Design-only, test, or approved implementation?

Core principle: an agent may prepare, classify, flag, and recommend. It must not autonomously send messages, make emergency decisions, or change a contractor's system without a separate approval gate.

End the Call Well, Then Send a Clean Handoff

CLOSE WITH THESE QUESTIONS

- If you could fix only one part first, what would it be?
- What would make this diagnostic useful even if no automation were installed?
- Who would approve a future implementation?
- What information should never be included in this workflow?
- How would your team know the process became clearer?
- What would a successful first 30-day test look like?

REFLECT THE DIAGNOSIS BACK

"What I heard is that requests arrive through [channels], ownership is unclear at [step/time], and dispatch often lacks [information] for the next step. I'll prepare a workflow map and rank the fixes. I will not access your systems or contact customers as part of this diagnostic."

SEND VERITAS THIS STRUCTURED HANDOFF AFTERWARD

```
Business type:
Primary workflow reviewed:
Main problem:
Lead/request channels:
Current tools:
People involved:
Current step-by-step process:
Most common failure:
Urgent or safety-sensitive cases:
Approximate request volume:
Existing statuses:
Current follow-up process:
Information dispatch needs:
Requested improvement:
Client-approved data boundary:
Client-approved non-goals:
Potential implementation constraints:
```

Include one or two sanitized examples if available. Then Veritas can produce the map, diagnosis, prioritized backlog, and implementation-readiness plan.

FINAL OPERATING RULE

Start with clarity, not tools. A well-defined manual process is the foundation for any safe automation. If the workflow, owner, and fallback are unclear, automation will only make the confusion faster.

Source lineage: prepared from the operator training conversation dated 2026-08-07; aligned with the existing AI Workflow Clarity Sprint HVAC Intake Discovery Script and synthetic demo. Internal training only. No external outreach, customer-system access, customer data collection, or implementation authority is implied.